

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 15

**PREVIOUS MAINS QUESTIONS
& PRACTICE QUESTIONS**



Q 01

Do you agree with the view that Muhammad Tughlaq was a transcendent failure? Explain.

Muhammad bin Tughluq was one of the most enigmatic figures in Medieval Indian History. He has been called a “mixture of opposites”, a transcendent failure by several historians and observers. The truth lies somewhere in between.

INSTANCES FOR WHICH HE IS CALLED A FAILURE:

- Shifting capital to Daulatabad from Delhi and then back to Delhi for better control on deccan
- Token Currency being poorly implemented
- Khurasan Expedition failure
- Doab Experiment.

REASONS FOR BEING A TRANSCENDENT FAILURE:

- Capital had to be reshuffled back to Delhi due to revolts in the Deccan i.e Bahamani & Vijayanagar kingdom formation
- Token coins had both merit and precedence but failed due to poor implementation
- Khurasan expedition failed due to change in Political situation in Central Asia
- Failure of raised taxes at doab was due to poorly done estimation by his officers

But, Muhammad bin Tughluq can not escape the blame completely because

- He undermined the Mongols capacity and overestimated his own military capabilities
- Daulatabad had water scarcity which was a major miss.
- He jumped the gun with Token currency without proper preparation

Hence what can be said is that he was a poor judge of character ,an excellent planner but poor in implementation. His ideas had high intellect but execution lacked requisite know how.

Q 02

“The inferior cavalry of the Rajputs was not the only cause of their defeat at the hands of Turko – Afghans” – Comment.

Right from the Sind invasion by the Muhammad Bin Kasim in 712 AD, Rajput Kings though very brave and valiant, lost to Islamic invaders leading to establishment of Turku-Islamic Rule in northern India. Superior Afghan Cavalry was indeed a factor but not the only reason for the fall of Rajputs :

- Indian Rulers relied more upon elephants in both attack and defensive campaigns.
- Muslims relied upon cavalry which gave them speed, swiftness and agility to strike deep.
- Rajput rulers weren't updating themselves in new warfare techniques and strategies

SOCIAL FACTORS:

- Only one caste i.e the Kshatriya Rajputs and their sub castes were supposed and allowed to fight

RELIGIOUS FACTORS:

- People of other religion i.e Buddhist and Jainism actively campaigned against the Rajputs.
- This low religious divide did not allow for a coordinated, united and strong response by the Indians.

POLITICAL FACTORS:

- There was constant battles among Rajput Kingdoms that weakened them.

CULTURAL FACTORS :

- Rajputs fought with honour, pride, rules and mutually agreed protocols. Islamic fighters had no such notions.
- Technological backwardness of Rajputs i.e the horseshoe, the saddle, which allowed Muslims to fire arrows, while on back of the horse.

Q 03**Examine the significance of Allauddin Khalji's administrative reforms.**

The 20 years rule of Alauddin Khalji (1290-1310 AD) is known for several reforms taken by him. Among them, his administrative reforms command central significance.

ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS:

- Inter marriage between nobles disallowed.
- Public consumption of alcohol and gambling was disallowed.
- Imposed heavy taxes on Sardars, Jagirdars, Ulemas, and Middlemen
- Elaborate system of spies and espionage
- Centralised administration with cash salary to officials
- Confiscating properties of Nobles
- Prior permission for organising gathering

SIGNIFICANCE OF REFORMS:

- Revolts and rebellions of nobles was checked.
- Mongol attacks were countered successfully
- By disallowing Ulems to interfere in politics, he successfully maintained a difference between Dindari (Godly Affairs) and Zahandari (Worldly Affairs)
- Removal of Muqaddams i.e intermediaries allowed for treasury to be filled to the brim and beneficial for the farmers

As long as Alauddin Khalji was alive, these steps were implemented both in letter and spirit, but later rulers lacked the leadership of Alauddin Khalji. His successors either did not believe in its efficacy or actively dismantled these reforms. It also created resentment among traders and businessmen due to fixed prices and too much interference of bureaucracy.

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